

Lab 05 - Pathfinder, Shape Builder and Masks

Course: Adobe Illustrator Fundamentals for Beginners (C037) Version: v1 | 4 October 2026

Scenario

Develop a product badge that combines overlapping geometry, a clipped image treatment and a soft transparency option.

Objective

Compare construction methods and select the most editable result for a badge system.

Supplied Illustrator/vector files

- clipping.ai
- compounds.ai
- pathfinders.ai
- shapeBuilder.ai

Detailed procedure

1. Open pathfinders.ai and save Lab05-Construction-Masks.ai.
2. Create the same core badge with Pathfinder and Shape Builder on separate layers.
3. Compare path count, editability and stray geometry; retain the stronger construction.
4. Create a compound path or shape that includes a deliberate counter or hole.
5. Use clipping.ai to build an image-in-shape treatment and a separate opacity-mask variation.
6. Inspect boundaries at high zoom, remove stray paths and document why the chosen method fits the brief.

Evidence to retain

Editable comparison layers, final badge, clipping and opacity-mask variations and method rationale.

Acceptance criteria

- [] The final badge has clean, intentional geometry.
- [] The chosen construction remains editable.
- [] Masks preserve source content.
- [] No stray or unintended paths remain.

Reflection prompts

- Which decision most improved the message or focal hierarchy?
- How does the Layers or Appearance panel prove that your technique remains editable?
- What rights or provenance evidence must accompany the finished image?